

HAWAII EXPRESS

**kō
kōwa
90/50**

RACE MANUAL

ROUTES

Considering that you have registered, it will hopefully not come as a surprise that this is not the easiest of rides. Kõrkõva has a new route every year, and this time it takes you across the islands.

The route has not been designed with the aim of reaching any particular destination as quickly or easily as possible. Instead, I have selected what I believe are the coolest roads and trails along the way. Sometimes you will have to push your bike or get your feet wet, but as the saying goes – it is all part of the adventure.

At the start of the race, you will have two options: complete the full 941 km loop or choose the shorter 581 km route. Everyone starts at the same time, but you must make your decision at the first checkpoint.

I have already marked many shops along the route, but please do your own research and do not rely blindly on the information provided – there are certainly more options available.

KÕRKÕVA 900 (941 km / ~4000 m)

[1/3 \(900/500\) KÕRKÕVA-26](#)

[2/3 \(900\) KÕRKÕVA-26](#)

[3/3 \(900\) KÕRKÕVA-26](#)

KÕRKÕVA 500 (581 / ~3000 m)

[1/3 \(900/500\) KÕRKÕVA-26](#)

[2/3 \(500\) KÕRKÕVA-26](#)

[3/3 \(500\) KÕRKÕVA-26](#)

ROUTE OVERVIEW

Broadly speaking, the bigger the island, the tougher the conditions. The mainland sections serve as the introduction and the comedown.

After the start at Hundipea, the first 11 kilometres will be neutralised. I will ride at the front of the group at a moderate pace of approximately 20–25 km/h.

As the group will be tightly packed at the beginning, drafting will be relatively difficult to avoid. Drafting is therefore allowed until kilometre 39. After the descent from the Türisalu cliff, drafting is prohibited.

Until the Türisalu cliff, the route follows the coastline in the setting sun. From there, you will continue through the darkness along gravel roads and small paved roads towards the port.

There are 24-hour petrol stations along the route in Keila and Risti – enjoy them, because you will not encounter such luxury again until you return to the mainland.

The section from the start to the first port will certainly be the fastest part of the race, with approximately 50% of it on paved roads.

Shops are few and far between on the islands, and there are no places open 24 hours along the route. Keep this in mind, study the route and make sure you can complete each upcoming section with enough food and water.

Shortly after the port, the first checkpoint is located in Paluküla. This is where you must decide which distance you are going to ride. By then, you should have developed some sense of how things are going, although the harder parts are still ahead.

As mentioned earlier, the route becomes progressively tougher as the islands get larger. There is nothing too extreme on Hiiumaa – you will encounter gravel roads of varying roughness and a few places where you may need to push your bike, mainly because of sand, but you keep your feet dry.

Reaching Saaremaa means entering the next level. This is especially true for the first group, who will arrive there on Saturday evening and continue riding through the night. There is a large shop in Leisi after the port, and it is worth fully restocking there, as there will be no other open shops along the route during the night.

Saaremaa also includes a few sections where you will have to walk through knee-deep water. The coastal tracks can be rough in places, but the views are spectacular.

Once Saaremaa is complete, only the small island of Muhu remains, with its surprisingly varied roads and trails.

Before the finish, you will encounter one of the most remarkable parts of the route – a winding singletrack trail along the Paldiski cliff. Take care here, as the trail runs very close to the cliff edge in places.

At the finish, I will be waiting for you with a beer from Vaat Brewery and the final stamp.

NB! In some places, the route passes through livestock gates that can be opened. Make sure you close them again after passing through.

IMPORTANT! ROAD SAFETY

The race takes place on open roads. All riders must obey traffic regulations, assess their own condition and make safety their highest priority.

I have planned the route to avoid busy roads as much as possible. However, both the start and finish are in the capital, so traffic cannot be avoided completely. Roads leading to ferry ports may also be busy, particularly immediately after a ferry has arrived.

In the event of an accident or another emergency, call 112 or ask local people for assistance. Use whatever help and resources are necessary in such a situation.

If you see another rider who needs help, stop and assist them. This is a self-supported race, but use common sense – if another rider is genuinely in trouble, you must help them.

After providing immediate assistance, assess the situation and only then inform me about what has happened. My telephone number is printed on the back of the brevet card.

Media vehicles will be travelling along the route, but there are many participants, and we are unlikely to be close enough to provide immediate assistance.

FERRIES

Ferries play a major role in this year's race. The longer route includes three ferry crossings, while the shorter route includes two.

The crossings provide an opportunity to rest and replenish supplies, but they may also test your nerves if you are at risk of missing a ferry.

Ferries between the mainland and the islands operate frequently. However, the ferry between the islands runs only three times a day and may have a decisive effect on the race.

Cyclists do not need to worry about reserving space on the ferries. You can simply join the live queue and ride onto the ferry, and tickets are relatively inexpensive. You may also purchase your tickets in advance.

Supplies can be purchased on all ferries.

Timetables and tickets for ferries between the mainland and the islands are available at praamid.ee

Information about the ferry between Hiiumaa and Saaremaa is available at veeteed.com

The Route and the Ferries

The ferry between Hiiumaa and Saaremaa was the biggest factor influencing the route design. The only Saturday departure that riders will catch is at 18:30. The next ferry does not leave until Sunday morning.

I have tried to design the route so that this ferry does not become too decisive. A reasonably large group of riders should be able to catch the 18:30 departure. The fastest riders will have some time to rest before the ferry, while others will have to push a little harder to make it.

Riders arriving on Hiiumaa aboard either of the first two morning ferries should be able to catch this departure.

From there, the race really gets going. Riders will reach Saaremaa at the beginning of the second evening, and the amount of rest they have had and how efficiently they have ridden up to that point will certainly begin to matter.

CATEGORIES

You may participate either solo or as a pair.

Riders must be completely self-sufficient. Outside assistance, drafting behind other riders, and sharing equipment, food or drink are not permitted.

The same principle applies to pairs. The two riders in a pair may support one another, share equipment and draft behind each other, but the pair as a whole may not receive any outside assistance.

The categories are:

- solo women;
- solo men;
- Pairs (mixed, women's and men's pairs)

Changing categories – if you change from the pairs category to the solo category during the race, or vice versa, you will be listed as a finisher but will not receive a position in the rankings.

For those who have never participated in one of our events or a similar ultra-distance cycling race: there are no prizes. Every finisher will receive a finish beer, while the category winners will receive a symbolic engraved top cap.

RACE BASE, START AND FINISH

Hundipea Kakaoladu, Tallinn

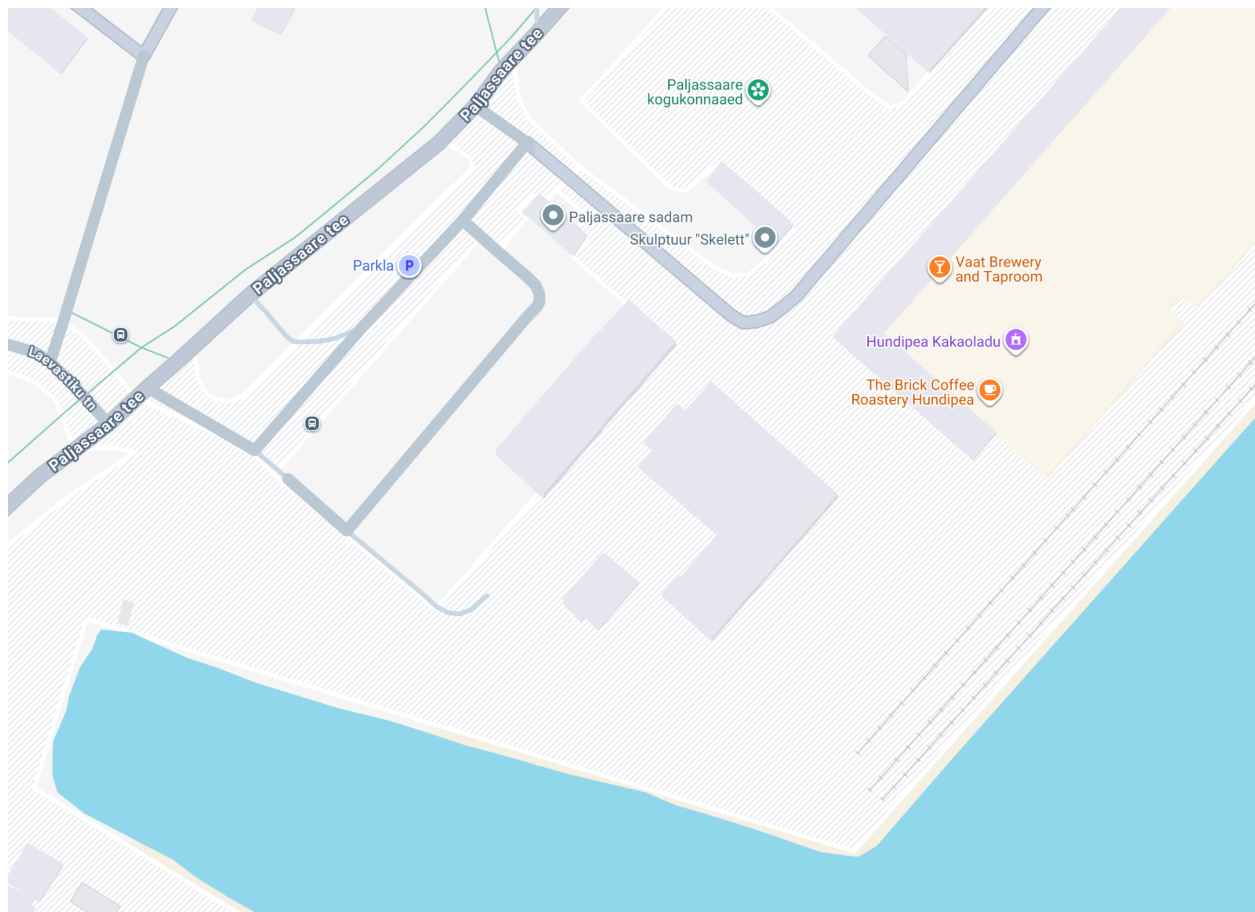
The race base, start and finish are located at Hundipea Kakaoladu in Tallinn, home to The Brick Coffee Roastery and Vaat Brewery. Essentially, this is a ride from a coffee shop to a brewery, with a small detour in between.

Race-pack collection begins at 18:00. From approximately 19:00, riders will be served a proper meal prepared by Indrek “Boss” Kaljuvee. Kaarel “Karu Pagar” Maaten will bake the bread to accompany the meal – pure power.

A short rider briefing will take place at 20:30, and the race starts at 21:00.

The first 11 kilometres will be neutralised. I will ride at the front of the group at a moderate pace of approximately 20–25 km/h.

You may leave a bag at the race base for the duration of the event, and parking will also be available if needed. You can park the car where the parking is marked on the map.



SCHEDULE

14 August

18:00 – Race-pack collection: GPS tracker, cap, brevet card and stickers

19:00 – Dinner, prepared by head chef Indrek “Boss” Kaljuvee

20:30 – Rider briefing

21:00 – START

21 August

21:00 – Final finishing deadline

CHECKPOINTS

START: Hundipea Kakaoladu, Tallinn

CP1: Paluküla, Hiiumaa

CP2 (900): Muhu

CP2 (500): Spithami

FINISH: Hundipea Kakaoladu, Tallinn

You must stamp your brevet card at every checkpoint. The stamps are accessible 24 hours a day.

Collecting the stamps is primarily intended to help maintain motivation and divide the journey into shorter sections.

The start, finish and first checkpoint are the same for both distances. The second checkpoint differs between the shorter and longer routes. You must choose your distance at the first checkpoint and stamp the corresponding section of your brevet card.

CP1: Paluküla, Hiiumaa – 200 km

The first checkpoint is located at the Paluküla Sports Centre near Kärkla on Hiiumaa.

This is a staffed checkpoint, where you will be welcomed by the legendary Rauno Viro. There is a small kitchen and showers. As a former mechanic, Rauno will also bring his tools and will be able to offer advice if necessary.

CP2 500: Spithami – 432 km

The second checkpoint of Kõkõva 500 is located in the birdwatching hut at Põõsaspea Cape in the village of Spithami.

The conditions are grotesque – there is one worn-out sofa in the hut where you can rest. The checkpoint is unstaffed, and you must stamp your brevet card yourself.

CP2 900: Muhu – 633 km

The second checkpoint of Kõkõva 900 is located at the Kallaste bus stop on the northern edge of Muhu Island.

It is an ode to the islands' extraordinary bus-stop culture, of which the Kallaste bus stop is one of the brightest examples. The checkpoint is unstaffed, and you must stamp your brevet card yourself.

RULES

Kõkõva 900/500 is, in principle, a simple race: you must complete the designated route by bicycle and under your own power.

The rules have largely been adopted from similar international races. The Self-Supported Riding section provides a more detailed explanation of our interpretation, as this may occasionally differ from that of other events.

1. Ride from the start to the finish along the designated route, passing through the two checkpoints listed in this manual and marked on the brevet card.
2. If you leave the route, for example to sleep or visit a shop, you must resume the race from the exact point where you left it.
3. Third-party assistance and private accommodation are prohibited. All food, drink and equipment must either be carried with you or obtained from places equally accessible to all riders.
4. Drafting is prohibited, except between the two riders competing as a pair.
5. The entire race must be completed under human power, with the exception of the ferries.
6. Riders must remain visible on the tracking map. Keep your tracker switched on.
7. Riders must know and follow all local traffic regulations.

Notes

This race is largely self-policed, and riders are trusted to complete it honestly and in good faith. However, if that trust is found to have been abused – for example, if a rider is photographed drafting behind another rider – the offending rider or riders will be removed from the race immediately and permanently.

We strongly encourage all participants to report possible rule violations by other riders. This should not be regarded as malicious behaviour towards the rider in question, but as a contribution to the entire racing community and to preserving an honest, self-policing racing culture.

Riders must follow not only the letter of the rules but also their spirit. If a rider is found to have broken, bent or attempted to circumvent the rules in order to gain an unfair advantage, each case will be assessed individually. The fact that a particular form of trickery is not explicitly covered by the rules does not mean that it will go without consequences.

SELF-SUPPORTED RIDING

No Outside Assistance

Riders are expected to be completely self-sufficient. They may not receive any form of outside assistance, whether that means help at the roadside or recommendations about where to sleep. Support vehicles are not permitted to follow riders, even if they are only there to provide moral support at stops.

Only services that are equally available to all riders may be used. You may not go to your own home or a friend's home to rest or eat dinner. A friend may not bring you food or spare parts. You may book a hotel room or visit a bicycle shop along the route and have your bike repaired, because these services are available to everyone.

You may not send supplies ahead or leave them anywhere along the route. You must carry all of your equipment with you. This also means that you may not discard or leave behind unnecessary luggage during the race.

Try to understand what the self-supported rules mean in practice and why they have been established. Everyone should have an equal opportunity to reach the finish.

If we discover that you have deliberately violated the rules in order to gain an unfair advantage, you will be removed from the race.

Drafting Is Prohibited

You may not draft behind anyone on the route. If you meet other riders, you may ride together for a while, but you may not draft. This restriction naturally does not apply to riders competing as a pair, who may draft behind one another.

We do not want to discourage riders from occasionally riding together and sharing their experiences. At the same time, this is a race, and the rules must also be fair to those riders who complete the entire route completely alone.

We will not specify exactly how long riders may ride together before it is considered pair riding. In principle, if you are riding with someone, it should be because you happen to be travelling at the same pace. Riding together should not be planned in advance, with coordinated breaks and sleeping arrangements.

“Trail Angels” and Help from Strangers

We do not prohibit spontaneous assistance, such as receiving water from the well of a randomly encountered farm beside the road.

However, such assistance must not be planned in advance. If a friend has come to the roadside to support you, or if a friend or acquaintance has a summer house beside the route, you may not accept assistance from them. No participant may receive a personal advantage.

Such assistance is permitted when:

- a local person offers it completely spontaneously;
- the same assistance would have been available to all riders;
- the assistance was not arranged in advance.

Helping Other Riders

Riders are not permitted to assist one another during the race. If you have to accept assistance from another rider, you will be listed as a finisher but will not receive a position in the rankings.

Use of Transport

The use of outside transport, such as a taxi, is permitted only in an emergency – for example, if your bicycle is broken and you require transport to the nearest town.

You must resume the race from the exact point where you left the route. Naturally, this exemption does not allow you to use transport between the route and a place where you intend to sleep.

MANDATORY EQUIPMENT

We have kept this list as short as possible.

- Front and rear lights
- Helmet
- Windproof or waterproof jacket
- Emergency blanket – these are extremely lightweight and may prove invaluable in an emergency

Check the upcoming weather conditions and be prepared for colder temperatures and rain. How exactly you deal with these conditions is your own decision.

In wet weather, otherwise fast gravel roads may turn into extremely slow and muddy tracks. Even if you plan to ride the shorter distance, we recommend carrying enough warm layers to survive a second night if necessary.

Last year, the proportion of riders who scratched was higher on the shorter route, particularly among riders who were not prepared for difficult conditions.

SCRATCHING

Stay safe – there is no shame in scratching.

If you find yourself unable to continue the race for any reason and decide to scratch, contact us as soon as possible by sending an SMS to +372 5650 5488 or an email to ultraratturiteliit@gmail.com.

Include as much information as possible about the circumstances of your withdrawal, including your rider number and full name.

After scratching, you are responsible for arranging your own onward travel. The organiser does not evacuate riders.

One of the best ways to travel from the islands back to the mainland is by Lux Express. Bicycle transport is free on their buses, and they operate services from both Hiiumaa and Saaremaa.

“Never scratch at night” is an old piece of wisdom among endurance riders. It means that you should always wait until morning before making major decisions, because things often look completely different after a night’s sleep.

TRACKING

Every rider will receive a GPS tracker, which we will use to display their position on the race map.

For clarity, this is not a navigation device.

It is the rider's responsibility to keep the device charged and operational.

The device should be positioned with its lights facing upwards and with as little other equipment covering it as possible.

GPS Tracker Instructions from SPORTREC

The GPS tracker should be charged every three days.

When the battery level falls below 10%, the device will slowly flash a red light. There is no reason to wait for this warning – it is better to charge the tracker in advance. The battery level can also be checked next to your name on the tracking page.

Each tracker comes with a USB-C charging cable. The tracker must not be charged while riding, as this is likely to interrupt its operation.

If the tracker battery becomes completely empty and the green light is no longer flashing, the device must be switched on after charging by pressing and holding the button on the top of the unit for six seconds.

At all other times, there is no need to press any buttons on the GPS tracker during the race.

The tracking link will be available during the race on our website at panepanepane.ee.

Social Media

There are people online watching your dot on the map who want to know how you are doing. Tag us in your Instagram posts and stories so that we can follow your journey: [@panepanepane.ee](https://www.instagram.com/panepanepane.ee)

Should you have any further questions, please feel free to ask.

Good luck,
Mathias Väärsi
Race Director